

Samsung BD-C8000

Samsung BD-C8000 is up coming with world's first portable 3D Blu-ray player

Nokia N900

Nokia N900 phone does face tracking for verification

Game review

Quake

is a series developed by iD Software, which has become synonymous with intense multiplayer action, and like *Unreal Tournament*, has given people a real taste for deathmatches and capture the flag games. Though the four-game series focussed on a story that followed a *Doom*-like marine protagonist fighting against alien monsters known as the Strogg, *Quake III Arena*, the least story-centric and the

a wide list of characters and species in the game settings, and are able to customise your railgun colour as well as team colour. There are hundreds of arenas, divided over the five match types: Free For All (Deathmatch), Capture The Flag, Clan Arena, Team Deathmatch, and Duel.

You can choose to play as a beginner, and if you are still unsure, you can either watch video tutorials in the Training Center, or Practice against computer controlled opponents.



Genre: FPS

Studio: iD Software

*Platforms: PlayStation 3, Xbox 360

Price: ₹1,999

Hop, skip & jump

most tournament-driven game of the four, is the most similar to *QuakeLive*.

Free-to-play and freshly out of beta (for Windows and Linux, Mac is still in beta), *QuakeLive* is a browser based (Firefox or Internet Explorer) first person multiplayer shooter that lets you pit your skills against players all over the world. Don't let the fact that there are countless deathmatch veterans out there daunt you...you can choose your match according to your skill level: Beginner, Intermediate, and Advanced.

Surprisingly easy to setup, you should be up and running (from registration to playing) in less than twenty minutes, including downloading the browser plugin and game data, if you have a relatively decent net connection. What was definitely the most pleasant surprise of the setup were the very decent ping times of 7-20ms, even playing in a US based match.

As for graphics, the game doesn't bring anything much newer than *Quake IV* or *Enemy Territories: Quake Wars* into the frame, but you can be assured of smooth graphics, with nary an 8-bit texture to remind you of those square pixel days. *QuakeLive* allows you to play in windowed or full screen mode, supporting resolutions as high as your graphics card can support i.e. 2560x1600. However, expect ping times to increase dramatically if you bulk up the graphics.

The controls are all user-defined, and the gameplay remains the same: multiplayer mayhem! You can choose your player from

If you missed out on the Quake movement over the years, here's your chance to catch up for free – online

On the whole, with its browser-based action, easy setup, simple interface, wide scale of graphics, and no-hassle match joining, *QuakeLive* is quite simply the easiest to connect multiplayer FPS you can play online, and in fact, might be the least troublesome online gaming experience you can find. If you do face any networking or game-related problems though, iD Software has a whole team waiting to help you out, who can be contacted by online form. *QuakeLive* also has an online community system, which allows you

to discuss, challenge or share amongst your online acquaintances and friends. Log on to *QuakeLive* at www.quakelive.com. **d**

